

Implement machine identity management for non-human entities (service accounts, IoT devices) in federal defense networks to close the identity gap in zero trust architectures.

Defense × Identity and access management × Zero trust architecture · OS100 v1 · refreshed 2026-08-18

ATTRACTIVENESS	RIGHT TO WIN	COMPETITION	SERVICEABLE MARKET	HORIZON	PORTFOLIO
75 is the world moving	68 can we play, can we win	MEDIUM 3 named in the evidence	€95.9m observed evidence · per year	NEXT regulation adopted or propose...	L0 13 signals

Attractiveness and right to win are scored and displayed separately and are never combined (SC-12). Competition is a fourth quantity, not a discount on either.

Evidence gap (SC-13). Orange has 0.0 published reference(s) in Defense, below the threshold of 5. A customer conversation here has no proof point behind it yet.

The opportunity

Machine identity management for non-human entities in federal defense networks is a critical but often overlooked component of zero trust architectures. This opportunity addresses the identity gap for service accounts and IoT devices, enabling secure, compliant operations. The time is now because federal zero trust mandates are expanding to explicitly cover machine identities, and defense networks are increasingly reliant on automated, non-human actors.

Market opportunity

Method	Total (TAM)	Serviceable (SAM)	Obtainable (SOM)	Confidence
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised	€95.9m	€95.9m	€3.4m	observed

All figures are annual, in EUR. Ranges compound the uncertainty of each factor below; the base case is the middle column of each.

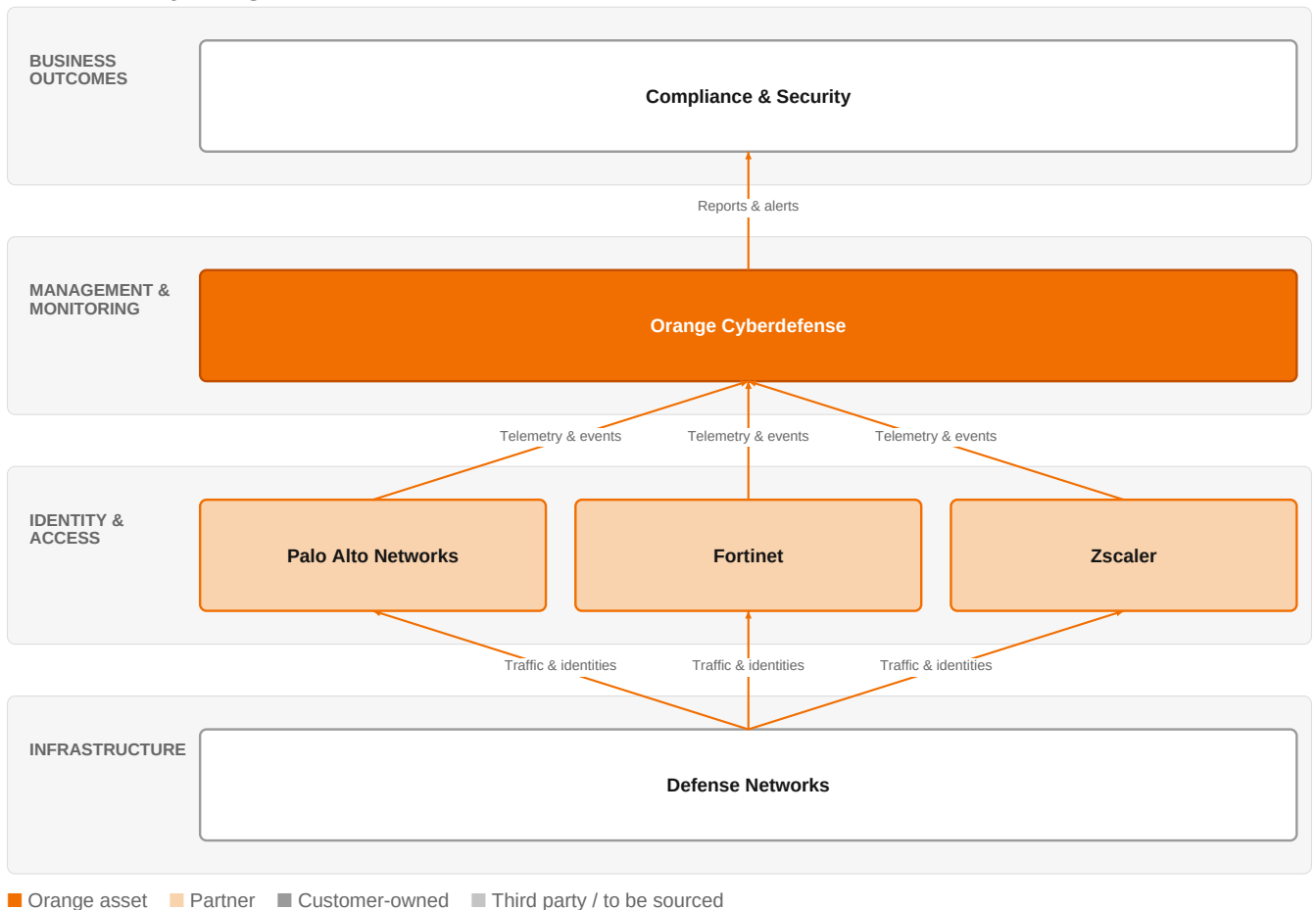
Observed: tendered contract value, annualised

Factor	Value	Basis	Source	As of
Tendered contract value in matching CPV categories	€95.9m per year	observed	TED (Tenders Electronic Daily) · ted	2026-05-21..2026-08-05
Assumed obtainable share of the serviceable market	3.5 % of SAM	assumption	config/sizing.yaml · obtainable_share	size-2026-08-a

Read this before quoting the number. Observed over 85 days of TED coverage and scaled to a year (x4.3); a short collection window makes that scaling rough. 5 matching notices, matched on vertical via the CPV crosswalk — §4.5.2's warning applies: a crosswalk error lands directly in this number. Public procurement only. Private-sector demand for the same capability is not visible here at all, so this is a floor rather than a market size. 1 of 1 declared geographies are outside the European reference data (US); the estimate covers the European footprint only.

The solution, in one picture

Machine Identity Management for Defense



Orange integrates partner identity platforms into a managed service that provides visibility and control over machine identities in defense networks.

Boxes marked as Orange assets are validated against the linked business graph; a box the model claimed for Orange without a matching asset is shown as third party.

What has changed

Federal zero trust strategies now explicitly recognize machine identity management as a critical component, as highlighted in FedTech Magazine's coverage of the nonhuman side of federal zero trust. The Department of War's enterprise post-quantum cryptography strategy, aiming to insulate defense networks by 2031, adds urgency to modernizing identity infrastructure. Industry analyses from IBM and Network World indicate that while zero trust is widely adopted, most organizations are implementing it incorrectly, often neglecting machine identities. The evolution of zero trust from identity to intent, as discussed in Veloxx media, signals a shift toward more dynamic, context-aware security models that require robust machine identity foundations.

Sources: SIG-5A3260810D62 FedTech Magazine 2026-06-08; SIG-FB099EF70AC5 Quantum Computing Repo 2026-07-01; SIG-686BD5025342 IBM 2026-05-28; SIG-E94A28E305BA Network World 2026-05-27; SIG-DECFC4C23DE4 Veloxx media 2026-07-31

Who buys, and why now

The buyer is typically the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) or the Director of Cybersecurity within a federal defense agency. The pain is operational: security teams struggle to track and manage thousands of service accounts and IoT devices, leading to unauthorized access and potential breaches. The trigger is often a compliance audit or a security incident that reveals gaps in machine identity coverage, forcing the organization to prioritize this issue.

Why it is hot now — every claim bound to a dated source

- Machine identity management is a critical part of federal zero trust strategies. [SIG-5A3260810D62]

What Orange would deliver, and why it can win

What Orange would deliver

Orange would assemble a managed service offering leveraging Orange Cyberdefense managed services, backed by cybersecurity experts and defense and security experts. The engagement would begin with an assessment of the customer's current machine identity landscape, followed by the deployment of identity management solutions using partners like Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler. Orange would then provide ongoing monitoring and management, ensuring compliance with ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications where applicable.

Why Orange can win

Orange can win by combining its managed security services with deep defense sector expertise and certified infrastructure (ISO 27001, SecNumCloud). The ability to integrate best-of-breed partner technologies (Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, Zscaler) into a cohesive managed offering is a differentiator. However, the assets are thin in terms of proprietary technology, so Orange must rely on its integration and management capabilities rather than unique technology.

Named assets behind this — each individually inspectable (LK-08)

Asset	Type	Link	Why it is linked	Curator
Orange Cyberdefense managed services	offer	L0	offer addresses the use case AND provides the technology	unconfirmed
Palo Alto Networks	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Fortinet	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
Zscaler	partner	L2	partner provides the required technology	unconfirmed
ISO 27001	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
SecNumCloud	certification	SUP	certification Orange holds is required by this vertical	unconfirmed
Cybersecurity experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Defense and security experts	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed
Orange Group researchers	capability pool	SUP	capability pool staffs this domain, vertical or technology	unconfirmed

Competitive landscape

MEDIUM competitive intensity (score 6.5; 3 of 8 listed players appear in this topic's own evidence)

A real field, including at least one player the customer will already know. Expect to be compared.

Competitors include security specialists like Palo Alto Networks, CrowdStrike, Fortinet, Zscaler, and Cisco, who sell zero trust architectures directly. Microsoft, as a hyperscaler, offers identity solutions integrated into its cloud platform. IBM, as a global systems integrator, provides consulting and implementation services. The customer will compare Orange's managed service approach against these point solutions and broader platforms, weighing the benefit of a single managed provider against best-of-breed components.

Sources: SIG-10E1BC61FB2F Palo Alto Networks 2026-05-12; SIG-333EF44491DD Microsoft 2026-04-29; SIG-686BD5025342 IBM 2026-05-28

Competitor	Category	Position here	Basis	Evidence
Palo Alto Networks	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	evidenced	SIG-10E1BC61FB2F
Microsoft	Hyperscaler	named in this topic's evidence — also an Orange partner	evidenced	SIG-333EF44491DD
IBM	Global systems integrator	competes in Cybersecurity	evidenced	SIG-686BD5025342
CrowdStrike	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity	structural	—
Fortinet	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Zscaler	Security specialist	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—
Cisco	Network equipment vendor	sells Zero trust architecture; competes in Cybersecurity — also an Orange partner	structural	—

Bechtle	Regional integrator or reseller	sells Zero trust architecture	structural	—
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evidenced means this topic's own sources name the competitor — the signal ids are in the last column and are dated and clickable in the radar. **structural** means the curated register says they sell this technology into this vertical, which is true but is not proof they are in this deal. Register version competitors-2026-08-a.

Qualifying questions for the first meeting

- 1 How do you currently manage service accounts and machine identities across your defense networks?
- 2 Have you experienced any security incidents or audit findings related to machine identities in the past year?
- 3 What is your timeline for complying with federal zero trust mandates, and does it include machine identity coverage?
- 4 Are you currently using any of the following platforms: Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, Zscaler, Microsoft, or Cisco for identity or security?
- 5 What is your biggest operational challenge with non-human entities: visibility, lifecycle management, or enforcement?
- 6 Do you have a dedicated team for identity and access management, or is it part of broader security operations?

Objections you will meet

They will say	You can answer
We already have a zero trust solution from a major vendor.	That's true, and many organizations have invested in zero trust. However, most are doing it wrong, especially regarding machine identities. Our managed service can complement your existing investment by focusing specifically on the non-human identity gap, ensuring comprehensive coverage.
We prefer to keep security in-house due to the sensitive nature of defense networks.	We understand the sensitivity. That's why we offer managed services that can be delivered on-premises or in sovereign cloud environments, with certifications like SecNumCloud. We also bring defense-specific expertise that many generalist providers lack.
This seems like a significant investment with unclear ROI.	The cost of a breach or non-compliance can be far higher. By addressing machine identities, you reduce the attack surface and improve audit readiness. Our managed service also reduces the burden on your internal teams, allowing them to focus on higher-value tasks.

Risks and unknowns

The main risk is that federal defense agencies may prefer to keep machine identity management in-house due to security sensitivities, limiting the market for managed services. Additionally, the specific regulatory requirements for machine identities in defense are still evolving, and it is unclear how quickly mandates will translate into procurement. The effectiveness of quantum-resistant identity solutions is not yet proven in operational defense environments.

Next action, by role (FR-17)

Role	Do this next
Presales / Proposal	Prepare a bid brief that differentiates our proposal by highlighting Orange's cybersecurity and defense experts, our ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications, and the integration of our managed services with partner technologies from Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler for machine identity management in federal defense networks.
Sales	In a meeting with a federal defense agency's CISO, say: 'Our managed services from Orange Cyberdefense, backed by ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud, can help close the identity gap for non-human entities in your zero trust architecture, and we can leverage our partnerships with Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler to deliver a comprehensive solution.'
Strategist / Innovator	Deep-dive brief on how Orange's cybersecurity experts and defense experts can leverage ISO 27001 and SecNumCloud certifications to build a machine identity management offering for federal defense networks, and assess the readiness of partners Palo Alto Networks, Fortinet, and Zscaler in this space.

Evidence

Every claim in this brief resolves to one of these. Tier 1 is an authoritative primary source; tier 4 is vendor-published material, discounted in scoring (§4.3.7).

Signal	Date	Publisher	T	Title and link
SIG-DA32C362F5E9	2026-01-12	openalex.org	1	FedQmc: A Federated Learning Backdoor Defense Method Based on Quantum State Encoding and Multis...
SIG-98BCC6F19BE4	2025-10-27	openalex.org	1	QuantumTrust-FedChain: A Blockchain-Aware Quantum-Tuned Federated Learning System for Cyber-Res...
SIG-2CC53D62856D	2025-08-18	openalex.org	1	A Hybrid Zero Trust Deployment Model for Securing O-RAN Architecture in 6G Networks
SIG-DECFC4C23DE4	2026-07-31	Veloxx media	2	From Identity to Intent: A Leader's Journey Through the Evolution of Zero Trust - Veloxx media
SIG-74A5048912D7	2026-07-10	Robotics & Automation News	2	How Zero Trust Network Access Eliminates Implicit Trust at Scale - Robotics & Automation News
SIG-FB099EF70AC5	2026-07-01	Quantum Computing Report	2	Department of War Unveils Enterprise Post-Quantum Cryptography Strategy to Insulate Defense Net...
SIG-5A3260810D62	2026-06-08	FedTech Magazine	2	Machine Identity Management: The Nonhuman Side of Federal Zero Trust - FedTech Magazine
SIG-686BD5025342	2026-05-28	IBM	2	Microsegmentation and zero trust: A natural fit - IBM
SIG-E94A28E305BA	2026-05-27	Network World	2	Zero trust isn't broken, but most companies are doing it wrong - Network World
SIG-CFBD245A217D	2026-05-24	Industrial Cyber	2	Zero trust in OT moves beyond identity as industrial operators prioritize visibility, segmentat...
SIG-10E1BC61FB2F	2026-05-12	Palo Alto Networks	2	Healthfirst Applies an Identity Security-First Approach to Implement Zero Trust - Palo Alto Net...
SIG-08B271ABAD4A	2026-04-30	iTnews	2	State of Security 2026: Zero Trust - iTnews
SIG-333EF44491DD	2026-04-29	Microsoft	2	Scale AI safely with Zero Trust security - Microsoft

How this brief was made

Computed, not written. Attractiveness, right to win, competitive intensity and every figure in the market-opportunity section are computed from stored inputs and can be re-derived (DR-05, NFR-01). No language model produced a number anywhere in this document (§4.4.4).

Written, then checked. The narrative sections and the solution diagram were generated from this topic's evidence and from the named asset and competitor lists. Factual sections must cite signal ids attached to this topic; sections that failed that check, or that contained a generated quantity or an unsupplied organisation, were removed rather than rewritten.

What	Version	When
Scores — weight set	w-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T19:08:26+00:00
Market sizing — assumptions	size-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:16+00:00
Competitor register	competitors-2026-08-a	2026-08-18T21:06:19+00:00
Narrative — prompt / model	describe-v1 / deepseek-chat	2026-08-19T04:56:57+00:00
Pipeline	0.1.0	2026-08-18

Generated 2026-08-19 04:58 UTC. Scores computed under a different weight set are not comparable with these (SC-10), and neither are market sizes computed under a different sizing version.